

Hoenn's Last Wish - Main Story Bible

Purpose and canon notation

This document is a writer-facing overview of the main story through the player's first defeat of Champion Stella. It organizes the existing narrative into chronology, dramatic acts, character arcs, relationships, revelations, and unresolved continuity questions.

The following labels are used where necessary:

- Established: directly stated or depicted in the intended player-facing story.
- Strong implication: not stated outright, but consistently supported by multiple events.
- Canon decision needed: the current scripts leave an important question unanswered or contain conflicting versions.
- Legacy text: dialogue inherited from Emerald that conflicts with the intended characters or plot and should not be treated as canon.

1. Story premise

Hoenn is living inside a repaired but unstable timeline.

In one possible future, Groudon and Kyogre devastated the region. Cities were flooded or consumed by volcanic destruction, wild Pokemon became dangerously aggressive, normal civilization collapsed, and even Poke Balls ceased to exist. Jirachi and Celebi used the opportunity created by the Millennium Comet to repair history, but the restoration was imperfect. The ruined future still exists as a temporal branch, and its accumulated grief leaks into the present through nightmare rifts.

In the restored present, most people believe the Millennium Comet was simply an extraordinary celestial event. A small number of researchers, mystics, and unusually sensitive people recognize that it changed reality. Professor Acacia sends the player and their rival to investigate. Luka experiences strange dreams and follows every lead connected to the comet. Calendula studies meteorite energy. Aurora treats the comet as a savior and searches for someone with the "gift" to heal damaged timelines.

At the same time, Team Magma and Team Aqua pursue Groudon and Kyogre. Their ideological conflict appears to be the central human threat, but both organizations are secretly being financed and manipulated by Mr. Stone and Devon Corporation. Mr. Stone wants the teams to locate the ancient titans and the Red and Blue Orbs. Once both sides have served their purpose, he intends to seize the titans' power and use it to control land, oceans, resources, shipping, and ultimately governments.

The player begins as a new Trainer, becomes an investigator into the comet, discovers an ability to remember and repair broken timelines, survives the nightmare rifts, exposes the struggle surrounding the titans, and ultimately saves Hoenn from the Primal forms of Groudon and Kyogre. The journey concludes with the player defeating Mr. Stone's granddaughter, Stella, and becoming Champion.

2. Central dramatic question

The story repeatedly contrasts two ways of changing the world:

- Control: Mr. Stone, Team Magma, and Team Aqua try to impose a preferred future through wealth, ideology, technology, and divine power.
- Restoration through relationship: the player succeeds by helping individuals, forming bonds with Pokemon, accepting help, and repairing what others tried to dominate.

The core dramatic question is therefore not simply whether Hoenn will survive. It is:

Will the future be dictated by those powerful enough to reshape the world, or protected by people willing to understand and care for it?

3. Cosmology and story rules

The original titan conflict

Groudon represents the land and Kyogre represents the sea. Their ancient struggle created earthquakes, eruptions, floods, and tsunamis. Their powers are not inherently evil, but they are too vast to be safely controlled by human ambition.

Rayquaza is the balancing force. It does not belong to either human faction and acts when the conflict between land and sea threatens the region as a whole.

The Millennium Comet

The comet is connected to Jirachi's awakening, temporal instability, meteorite fragments, and the restoration of the ruined future.

The current story supports two simultaneous interpretations:

- Researchers such as Acacia and Calendula regard it as a reality-altering phenomenon that can be studied through residual energy.
- Aurora regards it in spiritual terms as a savior that enabled the world to escape the path of ruin.

The comet should not necessarily be treated as a conscious moral agent. It may be the event that opens a temporal window and makes intervention possible, while characters interpret that event according to their own beliefs.

The broken future

The ruined version of Mossdeep is a real temporal branch, even though the player experiences it through a dreamlike state. Events there have meaning beyond an ordinary dream:

- The player's grandparents explain the collapse of Hoenn.
- The player encounters their rival and Luka in that future.
- The player collects the Time Gears of the Past, Present, and Future.
- Celebi restores temporal flow and Jirachi sends the player back.

Canon decision needed: Decide whether the player's body physically travels to the future, whether Jirachi projects the player's consciousness into a real branch, or whether the prologue is a prophetic reconstruction of events that canonically occurred. "Temporal projection into a real branch" currently reconciles the dream language with the lasting consequences most cleanly.

The gift

The player possesses a rare sensitivity Aurora calls "the gift." It allows the player to:

- Enter spaces between dreams and reality.
- Perceive temporal damage that most people cannot perceive.
- Borrow the power associated with Jirachi and Celebi.
- Enter nightmare rifts.
- Purify or sever a rift's connection to the present.
- Retain memories of timelines that have been restored.

The gift does not automatically make the player capable of succeeding. Aurora tests the player's strength because entering a rift without the will and skill to survive it would be useless or fatal.

Memory after restoration

When a damaged portion of history is restored, people without the gift remember the corrected reality rather than the crisis that was erased. The gifted retain awareness of what happened.

Luka's strange dreams suggest that non-gifted people may still receive incomplete temporal echoes. These are impressions rather than coherent memories.

Time Gears

Time Gears stabilize temporal flow. The three prologue gears embody Past, Present, and Future. A depleted Time Gear also anchors Nightmare Petalburg. Turning it after defeating Dark Suicune gives Celebi the opening needed to restore that part of the timeline.

Nightmare rifts

Nightmare rifts are places where the suffering of the broken future leaks into the restored world. They are not conventional alternate dimensions. They are wounds between timelines.

Their inhabitants are concentrated manifestations of trauma:

- Dark Suicune guards the distortion affecting Petalburg.
- Shadow Celebi and Shadow Jirachi embody the accumulated grief and destruction of the ruined future.

Defeating a shadow manifestation suppresses the active corruption. A legendary or Time Gear must still stabilize the boundary.

4. Factions and competing goals

Team Magma

Team Magma wants to expand the land and create what it considers a stronger or purer future. Its members interpret volcanic and terrestrial power as instruments of human progress. Magnus leads the organization; Netsu is a major administrator.

Magma steals a comet-linked Meteorite, attempts to manipulate Mt. Chimney, steals one of the sacred Orbs, awakens Groudon with the wrong Orb, and later attacks Mossdeep Space Center for rocket fuel.

The organization believes it is pursuing its own ideology, but Devon has been supplying resources and false research designed to push it toward Groudon.

Team Aqua

Team Aqua wants to expand the sea and believes oceanic power can be used to create a better world. Inae is the principal leader in the intended story. Alejandro acts as a senior captain and operational commander.

Aqua's activities include:

- Attacking Devon personnel.
- Occupying the Oceanic Museum.
- Seizing an abandoned ship and key shipping lanes.
- Corrupting Seabreeze Shipping.
- Occupying the Weather Institute.
- Stealing an Orb from Mt. Pyre.
- Stealing Captain Stern's submarine.
- Entering Seafloor Cavern and awakening Kyogre with the wrong Orb.

Their shipping campaign provides the logistical foundation for moving personnel, equipment, and ancient materials throughout Hoenn.

Devon Corporation

Devon initially appears to be a benevolent technology company repeatedly victimized by Team Aqua and Team Magma. Mr. Stone helps the player, provides useful technology, and requests seemingly innocent deliveries.

The truth is that Mr. Stone has funded and manipulated both teams. Devon's actual strategic goals are:

1. Encourage Aqua and Magma to locate the titans and Orbs.
2. Supply both factions with enough resources to continue without allowing either to achieve stable control.
3. Let their conflict expose every site and technology Devon needs.
4. Seize both Orbs once the titans are active.

5. Use Groudon and Kyogre to monopolize geography, energy, minerals, water, and trade.

Strong implication: Mr. Stone's gifts and friendly requests allow Devon to observe the player, the teams, Stella, and comet-related sites while maintaining the appearance of innocence.

5. Complete chronological timeline

Era I - Ancient history

1. Groudon and Kyogre shape the land and sea.
2. Their competing powers erupt into a catastrophic conflict.
3. Rayquaza becomes the force capable of ending or suppressing their struggle.
4. The Red and Blue Orbs become associated with the titans and their transformations.
5. Communities build shrines, preserve legends, and eventually safeguard the Orbs at Mt. Pyre.
6. Jirachi and Celebi become part of Hoenn's mythology surrounding wishes, time, and the possibility of changing fate.

Era II - The ruined branch of history

1. In one future, the balance fails and Groudon and Kyogre devastate Hoenn.
2. Flooding, volcanic activity, earthquakes, and uncontrolled wild Pokemon destroy normal civilization.
3. Mossdeep becomes a broken refuge populated by survivors.
4. Poke Balls and the ordinary Trainer system no longer exist.
5. Luka and the player's rival survive in this future and help protect others.
6. Celebi becomes trapped while temporal flow collapses.
7. Jirachi sleeps while the Millennium Comet approaches.
8. The Time Gears of Past, Present, and Future become scattered across ruined Mossdeep.

Prologue - Repairing the first broken future

1. Jirachi and Celebi introduce the history of Groudon and Kyogre in the Dream Realm.
2. The player accepts or skips the playable prologue. The event remains part of the story's historical foundation even if the player skips its gameplay.
3. In ruined Mossdeep, the player's grandparents describe Hoenn's destruction and give the player a Shiny Charm.
4. The player has no Pokemon and is attacked by a hostile Mightyena.
5. The rival gets the player back to safety.
6. The grandparents direct the player to Luka, whose Pidgeot can protect a route through the dangerous wild Pokemon.
7. Luka and Pidgeot hold the wild Pokemon back.
8. The player collects the Time Gear of the Past from the grass, the Time Gear of the Present from the rocks, and the Time Gear of the Future from the water.
9. The player frees Celebi. Celebi restores local temporal flow, calms the wild Pokemon, and calls a Wailord to create a crossing.

10. The player reaches Jirachi with Celebi and all three gears.
11. The Millennium Comet appears.
12. Jirachi and Celebi restore the timeline and return the player to the present.
13. The player awakens with the experience framed as a dream, but the later rift story confirms that the broken future remains a meaningful temporal branch.

Act I - A changed reality

Littleroot and Route 101

1. The player begins ordinary life in the restored present.
2. The player meets Zinnia or Zenno, the gender-dependent rival.
3. Professor Acacia is chased by a Sentret on Route 101.
4. The player chooses a starter and rescues her.
5. Acacia recognizes the player's potential and allows them to keep the starter.
6. The player battles the rival on Route 103.
7. The rival reveals an interest in the comet and Acacia's investigation.
8. Acacia gives the player a Pokedex and Town Map.
9. Acacia explains her belief that the Millennium Comet changed reality.
10. She sends both young Trainers into Hoenn to gather evidence.
11. Acacia directs the player toward Calendula, her research and romantic partner, who now leads the Petalburg Gym.

Dramatic function: The adventure begins as scientific fieldwork rather than a conventional Badge quest. The Gym journey provides the player with strength and access while the comet mystery supplies the real narrative objective.

Petalburg and Luka

1. Calendula introduces the player to Luka.
2. Luka is already investigating the comet and suffering from strange dreams.
3. Luka battles the player on Route 102. The story continues regardless of the result.
4. Calendula gives the player an Eevee Egg and Everstone.
5. She refuses an official Gym challenge until the player earns four Badges.

Dramatic function: Calendula becomes the player's distant benchmark, while Luka is established as a second kind of rival: less concerned with surpassing the player than with proving himself and understanding the comet.

Petalburg Woods and Rustboro

1. Two Aqua grunts attack a Devon employee in Petalburg Woods.
2. The player defeats them and receives an Ability Patch.
3. The incident presents Devon as a victim and Team Aqua as the immediate threat.
4. The player reaches Rustboro and defeats Gym Leader Terra.
5. A thief steals the Devon Goods and flees toward Route 116.
6. The player pursues the thief into Rusturf Tunnel.

7. The player defeats the Aqua grunt, recovers the Devon Goods, and rescues Mr. Briney's Nami.
8. The Devon employee gives the player an Ability Capsule and introduces them to Mr. Stone.
9. Mr. Stone asks the player to deliver a Letter to Stella and the Devon Goods to Captain Stern.
10. He gives the player the DexNav.
11. The rival challenges the player in Rustboro and gives them the Exp. Share after losing.
12. Mr. Briney agrees to sail the player to Dewford.

Dramatic function: Mr. Stone recruits the player under the guise of gratitude. His generosity makes the later betrayal personal and credible.

Act II - Omens beneath the ordinary journey

Dewford, Aurora, and Stella

1. Aurora blocks the way into Granite Cave.
2. She claims the comet granted her visions and power.
3. She senses unusual energy in the player and challenges them.
4. After losing, she warns of a coming crisis and gives the player Flash.
5. The player defeats Renton and earns the right to use Flash.
6. Inside Granite Cave, Team Magma searches ancient areas associated with rare minerals and old power.
7. The player defeats the Magma members and reaches Stella.
8. Stella initially suspects the strangely dressed player may be connected to Magma.
9. The player delivers Mr. Stone's Letter.
10. Stella gives the player TM Steel Wing.
11. She shows the player an ancient image of the land and sea titans.
12. Stella wonders whether the painting, Team Magma, and the comet are connected.
13. If the player reports back, Mr. Stone rewards them with a Shiny Stone.

Dramatic function: Aurora establishes the supernatural interpretation of the comet. Stella establishes the archaeological interpretation. Mr. Stone remains positioned as a helpful patron connected to both.

Slateport and Mauville

1. The player delivers the Devon Goods to Captain Stern at the Oceanic Museum.
2. Team Aqua confronts Stern.
3. The player defeats the grunts.
4. Alejandro states Aqua's maritime ideology and withdraws.
5. The player battles the rival on Route 110 and receives the Dowsing Machine.
6. In Mauville, Luka asks for another battle while arguing with his uncle about challenging the Gym.
7. Luka loses and recognizes that his comet research has displaced some of his training.
8. The player defeats Den and continues west.
9. The player obtains Rock Smash and later Strength through the Rusturf Tunnel reunion.

Dramatic function: Aqua's interest expands from theft to control of the sea. Luka's two priorities-understanding the comet and becoming stronger-begin to compete.

Meteor Falls and Mt. Chimney

1. Team Magma steals a Meteorite fragment connected to the Millennium Comet.
2. Magma believes the fragment carries a memory of a lost or forgotten world.
3. Team Aqua arrives and pursues Magma, presenting itself as the faction preventing a greater disaster.
4. Inae warns the player that the stakes are beyond ordinary League battles.
5. Calendula reveals that the grunts tried to seize her research.
6. She detects unexplained comet-related energy in the meteorite and cavern walls.
7. Calendula leaves to compare her samples with data at Mossdeep Space Center.
8. At Mt. Chimney, the player defeats Netsu.
9. The player defeats Magnus at the meteorite machine.
10. Magnus fails to reshape the volcano as intended.
11. The player removes the Meteorite.
12. The player defeats Amaterasu in Lavaridge.
13. The rival gives the player the Go-Goggles, opening the desert route.

Dramatic function: The human factions make their first direct attempt to weaponize comet-related material. Calendula's research creates the intended bridge between the scientific mystery and the villain plot.

Act III - The first present-day rupture

Petalburg's disaster

1. After the fourth Badge, the player returns to find Petalburg under unnatural rain and earthquakes.
2. Calendula has left after receiving a mysterious letter promising answers in Phoenix Town.
3. The Petalburg Gym is closed while the crisis continues.
4. The player crosses the desert to Phoenix Town.
5. Calendula, Luka, and the rival are waiting there.
6. Luka states that every lead he has followed connects the comet to the unnatural events.
7. Aurora reveals that she sent the letter.
8. Aurora describes the comet as a savior and says other forces are pushing the world back toward the path of ruin.
9. She explains that only someone with the gift can be taught to heal the damage.
10. Aurora rejects Luka and the rival as candidates.
11. She senses the gift in the player but demands proof of their strength.
12. The player defeats Aurora.
13. Calendula sends Luka and the rival back to help protect Petalburg while the player follows Aurora.

Aurora Grove

1. The player passes through Phoenix Cave into Aurora Grove.
2. Aurora explains that the Grove exists between dreams and reality.
3. Entry confirms that the player can interact with damaged timelines.
4. Aurora explains that Jirachi and Celebi repaired the world before, but their restoration was not permanent or all-powerful.
5. The current timeline is fraying and nightmare energy is leaking through it.
6. Aurora teaches the player how to borrow the legends' power, enter a nightmare rift, and sever its connection.
7. She warns that restoring history will erase the event from the memories of people without the gift.
8. She predicts additional rifts.

Nightmare Petalburg

1. The player returns to Petalburg and reunites with Calendula, Luka, and the rival.
2. A new quake knocks the player unconscious and draws them into Nightmare Petalburg.
3. The nightmare presents a distorted local history, including signs of a world that does not know Luka.
4. Dark Suicune guards the temporal corruption.
5. The player defeats Dark Suicune and receives a Comet Shard.
6. The player reaches the depleted Time Gear and turns it.
7. Celebi restores the damaged portion of the timeline.
8. Celebi reminds the player that most people will not remember what was changed.
9. The player awakens in restored Petalburg.
10. Calendula's Gym becomes accessible.
11. The player defeats Calendula and receives the fifth Badge.
12. Luka's family gives the player Surf in gratitude for their influence on him.
13. Luka challenges the player outside and warns that Aqua and Magma are mobilizing again.

Dramatic function: The player stops being merely an investigator. They become the only active human guardian of the repaired timeline.

Act IV - The war for Hoenn's infrastructure

Abandoned Ship

1. Aqua blocks routes and occupies the Abandoned Ship.
2. The player uses Surf to reach it.
3. The player finds the keys needed to access the occupied rooms.
4. The ship's records reveal a focus on strategic transport routes.
5. The player defeats a grunt and confronts Inae.
6. Inae states that the ship is only one part of a larger operation.
7. Stella arrives after tracking the vessel for three days.

8. Inae refuses a two-against-one confrontation and withdraws, saying Aqua already obtained what it needed.
9. Stella explains that Aqua is seizing ports, supply lines, and major shipping lanes.

Cargo Ship and Seabreeze Shipping

1. Luka finds evidence of Aqua loading a cargo ship in Slateport.
2. The player and Luka board it.
3. Luka uses Pidgoot to distract a sailor and gain access to the hold.
4. The player finds the Seabreeze Shipping HQ Key Card.
5. Luka returns to report the discovery to Calendula.
6. The player uses the card to enter the restricted Seabreeze offices.
7. Aqua grunts occupy the building.
8. The player overhears Alejandro arranging disguised shipments with the company president.
9. Alejandro reveals that a signal has already been sent to the team on Route 121.
10. Alejandro and the president escape.
11. The accountant Juan is forced to battle the player.
12. The exposure of Seabreeze breaks the immediate shipping operation and opens the eastern route.

Dramatic function: Aqua becomes a systemic threat rather than a collection of criminals. The arc should also provide the strongest pre-reveal opportunity to seed Devon's hidden involvement.

Act V - The Orbs and the second temporal wound

Weather Institute, rival, and Fortree

1. Team Aqua occupies the Weather Institute to gain access to climate data and technology.
2. The player defeats the occupying administrator and frees the researchers.
3. The researchers offer the player Castform.
4. The rival challenges the player immediately afterward and gives them Fly.
5. Stella meets the player on Route 120.
6. She uses the Devon Scope to reveal an invisible Kecleon and gives the device to the player.
7. The player defeats Taka in Fortree.

Mt. Pyre

1. Aqua moves toward Mt. Pyre after the Seabreeze operation is exposed.
2. Magma secretly reaches the sacred site by another route.
3. Magnus tells the player that Aqua rushed to the summit without noticing Magma slipping away.
4. At the summit, the player battles through Aqua.
5. Inae escapes with one sacred Orb.
6. Magma has already taken the other.
7. The shrine keeper gives the player the Magma Emblem, allowing access to the hidden Jagged Pass base.
8. The keepers recount the legend of the chosen one beside statues of Jirachi and Celebi.

9. A temporal rift opens and pulls the player into the Nightmare Realm.

Nightmare Realm

1. Jirachi and Celebi are pursued by Shadow Jirachi and Shadow Celebi.
2. The true legends explain that the shadows are grief, loss, and devastation from the broken future given purpose and form.
3. The shadows recognize the player as the person capable of erasing them.
4. The player defeats both shadows in a forced double battle.
5. Jirachi and Celebi explain that the rift still requires anchoring from their side.
6. They describe time as a branching river rather than a single road.
7. The ruined future cannot be made never to have existed, but its tragedy does not have to repeat in every branch.
8. The legends remain behind to guard the boundary.
9. The player returns to Mt. Pyre.

Dramatic function: The nightmare threat escalates from one corrupted city to direct attacks on the legendary beings sustaining the repaired world.

Act VI - Awakening the titans

Magma Hideout and Groudon

1. The player uses the Magma Emblem at Jagged Pass.
2. The hidden Magma base opens inside a former Devon mine.
3. The player unexpectedly finds Mr. Stone near the entrance.
4. Mr. Stone claims he is merely inspecting an old Devon property now occupied by dangerous criminals.
5. He quickly leaves, marking the clearest pre-reveal evidence of his hidden involvement.
6. The player fights through the base and defeats Netsu near the deepest chamber.
7. Magnus uses the wrong Orb to awaken Groudon.
8. Groudon escapes instead of obeying him.
9. Magnus blames the player, loses the ensuing battle, and leaves to pursue Groudon.

Submarine theft and Aqua Hideout

1. Captain Stern publicly discusses the discovery of an undersea cavern.
2. Team Aqua announces that it will seize the Explorer 1 submarine.
3. Aqua escapes with the vessel.
4. The player enters the Aqua Hideout near Lilycove.
5. The player defeats the administrator delaying pursuit.
6. The submarine escapes toward Seafloor Cavern.
7. The rival waits outside the Lilycove Department Store for a major battle.
8. After losing, the rival acknowledges the player's growth and returns to Littleroot to train.

Mossdeep Gym and Space Center

1. The player reaches Mossdeep and defeats Soul and Luna for the seventh Badge.
2. Team Magma attacks the Space Center for rocket fuel.
3. Calendula's Meteor Falls samples are being compared with the comet's flight data inside the facility.
4. The player fights through the occupying grunts.
5. Stella asks the player to join her in battle.
6. Together they defeat Magnus and Netsu.
7. Magnus questions whether both Magma's and Aqua's ideologies are fundamentally misguided.
8. Stella invites the player to her home.
9. Stella gives the player Dive and points them toward the undersea cavern.

Seafloor Cavern and Kyogre

1. The player dives on Route 128 and follows the stolen submarine into Seafloor Cavern.
2. The player navigates the cavern and defeats Aqua's defenders.
3. The player confronts Inae beside the sleeping Kyogre.
4. Inae loses but uses the wrong Orb to awaken Kyogre.
5. Kyogre escapes instead of obeying her.
6. An uncontrollable downpour begins.
7. Magnus arrives and recognizes that the two awakenings may destroy all of Hoenn.
8. Magma and Aqua abandon their immediate conflict and travel to Sootopolis.

Dramatic function: Both ideological leaders receive the same lesson: awakening a god is not the same as controlling it.

Act VII - The true architect and the end of the crisis

Groudon and Kyogre clash

1. Groudon and Kyogre converge in Sootopolis.
2. Their battle produces extreme weather and threatens the entire region.
3. Magnus and Inae are unable to make either titan respond to the Orbs they used.
4. Stella prepares to seek a legendary solution.

Mr. Stone's betrayal

1. The player approaches Mr. Stone at the southern riverbank.
2. Mr. Stone reveals that Aqua and Magma were never meant to win.
3. Devon funded both organizations and gave each side the resources and research needed to continue.
4. The teams' rivalry allowed Devon to locate the titans and both Orbs without openly accepting the risk.
5. Mr. Stone thanks Magnus and Inae for unknowingly acting as Devon's mercenaries.
6. He explains the Stone family's multigenerational obsession with minerals and ancient beings.

7. He reveals that Devon scientists deliberately taught the teams to use the wrong Orbs.
8. Mr. Stone dismisses Pokemon training and the League as insignificant beside power capable of reshaping continents.
9. He specifically belittles Stella's achievement as Champion.
10. He declares his intention to control land, water, energy, minerals, maritime routes, governments, and ultimately the world economy.
11. Mr. Stone boards a Devon boat with both Orbs.
12. He forces Groudon and Kyogre into their Primal forms.
13. The disaster intensifies.
14. Magnus and Inae recognize that Devon exploited their ideals and that no human can control the titans.

Cave of Origin and Rayquaza

1. Stella leads the player to the Cave of Origin.
2. The ancient expert explains that a third legendary power is required.
3. The player learns that Rayquaza waits at Sky Pillar.
4. The player travels through Pacifidlog and climbs Sky Pillar.
5. The player awakens Rayquaza.
6. Rayquaza flies to Sootopolis.
7. Rayquaza confronts the Primal titans and ends their battle.
8. Groudon and Kyogre leave Sootopolis.
9. Normal weather returns.
10. Magnus and Inae accept that their schemes were insignificant beside the beings they tried to command.
11. They leave, intending to return the Orbs to Mt. Pyre.

Canon decision needed: Mr. Stone possesses both Orbs when he departs, but Magnus and Inae later possess and return them. A recovery event is required between Rayquaza's arrival and their departure.

Eighth Badge

1. The Sootopolis guide thanks the player and gives them Waterfall.
2. The player challenges Rio.
3. The player earns the eighth Badge and gains access to the Pokemon League.

Act VIII - The human conclusion

Ever Grande and Victory Road

1. The player reaches Ever Grande using Waterfall.
2. The rival demands one final test before the League.
3. After losing, the rival admits they are not yet ready for the Elite Four but promises to continue training.
4. Inside Victory Road, Luka challenges the player.

5. Luka's battle represents the culmination of his own effort to balance research, dreams, and training.
6. Luka loses but refuses to stop growing.
7. The player completes Victory Road.

Elite Four and Stella

1. The player defeats Tsubaki, Iara, Stark, and Daemon.
2. Stella awaits as Champion.
3. The player defeats Stella and becomes the new Champion.
4. The rival arrives moments too late to offer advice.
5. Professor Acacia arrives, evaluates the Pokedex, and congratulates the player.
6. Stella escorts the player into the Hall of Fame.

Canon decision needed: Stella's current Champion dialogue is largely inherited from Wallace and does not resolve her relationship with Mr. Stone. Her final battle should serve as the emotional conclusion of her arc and the thematic answer to her grandfather's philosophy.

6. Major character arcs

The player

Starting position: An ordinary young person with no established status or understanding of Hoenn's hidden history.

External arc:

1. Survives or witnesses the ruined future.
2. Becomes a Trainer by rescuing Acacia.
3. Accepts Acacia's investigation into the comet.
4. Grows through the Gym challenge and rival battles.
5. Becomes entangled in Aqua and Magma's conflict.
6. Is identified by Aurora as possessing the gift.
7. Learns to enter and repair nightmare rifts.
8. Protects Celebi and Jirachi from their shadows.
9. Discovers Mr. Stone's conspiracy.
10. Awakens Rayquaza and saves Hoenn.
11. Defeats Stella and becomes Champion.

Internal arc: The player moves from reacting to immediate danger toward consciously accepting responsibility for events nobody else can remember or fully understand.

Thematic function: The player changes the world without trying to own it. Their power comes from relationships, accumulated acts of help, and the willingness to carry memories others cannot.

Professor Acacia

Role: Professor, scientific instigator, mentor, and Calendula's partner.

Established involvement:

- Suspects the Millennium Comet changed reality.
- Gives the player and rival their investigative mission.
- Frames Pokedex fieldwork as a method of detecting what changed.
- Directs the player to Calendula.
- Returns after the Champion battle.

Arc: Acacia begins as the first scientist willing to question consensus. Her faith in the player is vindicated when they uncover a crisis beyond conventional research and become Champion.

Current weakness: She disappears from most of the middle and climax. Her scientific premise is important, but she does not presently deliver a major discovery.

Best payoff: Acacia should connect Devon technology found across Aqua and Magma operations, while Calendula connects the comet energy and temporal rifts. Together they can expose the human and supernatural halves of the conspiracy.

Calendula

Role: Petalburg Gym Leader, researcher, Acacia's partner, mentor, and protective authority figure.

Established involvement:

- Introduces the player to Luka.
- Gives the player an Eevee Egg and Everstone.
- Sets four Badges as the threshold for challenging her.
- Researches unexplained changes in Meteor Falls.
- Is threatened by Magma for her research.
- Sends comet-linked samples to Mossdeep Space Center.
- Responds to Aurora's letter and the Petalburg disaster.
- Protects the city while the player follows Aurora.
- Becomes the fifth Gym challenge after the nightmare is repaired.

Arc: Calendula moves from testing the player's ordinary Trainer development to trusting them with a danger that conventional adults cannot confront. Her pride in the player is based as much on compassion as battle strength.

Current weakness: Her research reaches Mossdeep, but she does not personally announce the conclusion or participate in the climax.

Best payoff: Calendula should discover that meteorite and Orb activity correlates with the rifts, validating Acacia and explaining why Petalburg and Mt. Pyre become temporal fault points.

Luka

Role: Friend, secondary rival, comet investigator, and emotional bridge between the normal world and the ruined future.

Established involvement:

- Exists in both the ruined future and restored present.
- Uses Pidgeot to protect the player in the prologue.
- Experiences strange dreams after the comet.
- Researches the comet obsessively.
- Battles the player in Petalburg, Mauville, after the fifth Gym, and in Victory Road.
- Accompanies Calendula and the rival to Phoenix Town.
- Trusts the player when Aurora selects them.
- Discovers Aqua's cargo ship operation.
- Helps the player infiltrate the ship and find the Seabreeze Key Card.

Arc: Luka initially tries to prove himself through bravery and battle while being pulled toward the comet mystery by dreams he cannot explain. Repeated losses teach him that determination without balance is not enough. His investigation becomes genuinely useful during the Aqua shipping arc. At Victory Road, he is no longer asking whether he is worthy to begin; he is measuring how far he has come.

Strong implication: Luka's dreams are temporal echoes of the ruined branch and his role there.

Best payoff: His Victory Road scene should acknowledge that the dreams led him here and either stopped after Rayquaza restored balance or changed into a hopeful vision of Hoenn's future.

Zinnia or Zenno - the rival

Role: Peer, recurring battle rival, Acacia's field assistant, and witness to the player's growth.

Established involvement:

- Helps Acacia gather Pokedex data.
- Shares the comet investigation.
- Exists in the ruined future and rescues the player after the Mightyena attack.
- Battles the player on Route 103, in Rustboro, Route 110, Route 119, Lilycove, and Ever Grande.
- Travels with the player to Dewford.
- Gives the player the Exp. Share, Dowsing Machine, Go-Goggles, and Fly at key stages.
- Joins Calendula and Luka in Phoenix Town.
- Questions whether Aurora can be trusted.
- Returns after the Champion battle.

Arc: The rival begins as an enthusiastic research peer and friendly competitor. As the player becomes involved in dangers the rival cannot enter, competition gives way to respect. The Ever Grande loss forces the rival to accept that they are not yet ready for the League without abandoning the desire to improve.

Current weakness: The rival is present at important transitions but has little direct effect on the late crisis.

Best payoff: Give the rival a concrete action during Sootopolis-evacuating residents, delivering Acacia's evidence to Stella, or coordinating transport-so their research journey contributes to the resolution.

Aurora

Role: Mystic, prophet, gatekeeper of the gift, and interpreter of the Millennium Comet.

Established involvement:

- Feels called or empowered by the comet.
- Receives visions of a coming crisis.
- Senses unusual energy in the player at Granite Cave.
- Gives the player Flash after testing them.
- Sends Calendula the letter leading the group to Phoenix Town.
- Calls the comet a savior.
- Identifies the player as gifted.
- Tests whether the player has the strength to survive the rifts.
- Brings the player to Aurora Grove.
- Teaches them how to enter and purify nightmare spaces.
- Warns that restored events will be forgotten.

Arc: Aurora begins with certainty: she believes the comet has shown her the path and that the gifted must follow it. Selecting the player turns her from remote prophet into teacher.

Current weakness: Her arc ends immediately after she grants the ability, so her beliefs are never tested by the climax.

Best payoff: Aurora should return after the Nightmare Realm or Sootopolis and recognize that the comet offered a possibility, not a guaranteed salvation. The player's choices completed what prophecy could not.

Jirachi

Role: Wish-granting legendary, narrator of the ancient disaster, and one of the two anchors of the repaired timeline.

Established involvement:

- Introduces the titan conflict and the possibility of changing fate.
- Sleeps in the ruined future until the player frees Celebi and collects the Time Gears.
- Uses the Millennium Comet to help restore the timeline.
- Appears in the Nightmare Realm under attack from its shadow counterpart.
- Explains that Hoenn's fate is made from many interconnected temporal threads.
- Remains behind to anchor the rift.

Arc: Jirachi moves from the seemingly limitless mythology of wish fulfillment to an admission that even legendary power has limits. A wish can open a future, but people must sustain it.

Celebi

Role: Guardian of temporal flow, guide through restoration, and one of the two anchors of the repaired timeline.

Established involvement:

- Is trapped in the ruined future.
- Requires the three Time Gears to restore local flow.
- Calms wild Pokemon and creates the path to Jirachi.
- Restores Nightmare Petalburg after the player defeats its guardian and turns the Time Gear.
- Warns that restoration changes memory.
- Appears in the Nightmare Realm under attack from its shadow counterpart.
- Explains that time is a branching river.

Arc: Celebi embodies the cost of restoration. Repair does not mean erasing the moral reality of what occurred, and the player must carry memories the rest of the world loses.

Stella Stone

Role: Archaeologist and explorer, Devon heiress, recurring ally, Mr. Stone's granddaughter, and Champion of Hoenn.

Established involvement:

- Studies the titan painting in Granite Cave.
- Receives Mr. Stone's Letter and gives the player Steel Wing.
- Tracks Aqua to the Abandoned Ship and confronts Inae.
- Warns that Aqua's control of shipping could silence the region.
- Encounters the player on Routes 118 and 120.
- Gives the player the Devon Scope.
- Fights beside the player against Magma at the Space Center.
- Gives the player Dive.
- Leads the player to the Cave of Origin.
- Directs the search toward Rayquaza and Sky Pillar.
- Is revealed by Mr. Stone to be his granddaughter and the Champion.
- Is dismissed by him as insignificant beside divine power.
- Serves as the player's final League opponent.

Arc: Stella begins as an independent explorer using her family's resources to understand the ancient world. She gradually becomes the player's most capable field ally. The revelation that her grandfather funded both teams turns the crisis into a personal betrayal. Her identity as Champion positions her to answer his belief that domination is greater than partnership.

Current weakness: The current Champion dialogue does not acknowledge that betrayal, and the story does not show Stella confronting the consequences for her family or Devon.

Best payoff: Stella should battle the player partly to reaffirm what the title of Champion means after Mr. Stone mocked it. Her defeat should represent a hopeful transfer of responsibility rather than an unrelated League formality.

Mr. Stone

Role: Patron, hidden architect of the faction war, corrupt industrialist, and principal human antagonist.

Public face:

- Grateful Devon president.
- Victim of repeated Aqua thefts.
- Supporter of promising young Trainers.
- Concerned grandfather sending a letter to Stella.
- Provider of the DexNav and other rewards.

True involvement:

- Funds both Aqua and Magma.
- Supplies selective or false research.
- Uses the teams to find the titans and Orbs.
- Maintains ties to the mine containing Magma's base.
- Allows both groups to awaken the titans incorrectly.
- Takes both Orbs once the titans are exposed.
- Forces the Primal Reversions.
- Seeks economic and geopolitical control rather than ideological victory.

Arc: Mr. Stone begins as the model of respectable power. Each apparent act of generosity deepens the player's participation in a system he controls. At Sootopolis, the mask drops: he regards people, factions, Pokemon, and even Stella as assets or obstacles.

Thematic function: Stone is the purest embodiment of control. Magma and Aqua at least believe they are creating a better world; Stone believes ownership itself justifies his actions.

Current weakness: He escapes the crisis without a stated fate, leaving the principal human antagonist unresolved before the League ending.

Magnus

Role: Leader of Team Magma and ideological antagonist manipulated by Devon.

Established involvement:

- Directs the theft of the comet-linked Meteorite.
- Attempts to use Mt. Chimney to reshape the region.
- Steals one Orb from Mt. Pyre.
- Awakens Groudon with the wrong Orb.

- Attempts to steal rocket fuel and erupt the volcano.
- Begins questioning Magma's ideology after repeated failures.
- Recognizes the danger after Kyogre awakens.
- Learns in Sootopolis that Mr. Stone used him.
- Accepts that the titans cannot be controlled.

Arc: Magnus moves from absolute ideological confidence to humiliation, doubt, and recognition of responsibility. His redemption is not complete, but he finally prioritizes preventing destruction over defeating Aqua.

Netsu

Role: Major Magma administrator and Magnus's committed subordinate.

Established involvement:

- Defends the Mt. Chimney operation.
- Helps protect the Magma Hideout and Groudon's chamber.
- Participates in the Space Center attack.
- Fights beside Magnus against the player and Stella.

Arc: Netsu functions as a measure of institutional loyalty. Where Magnus eventually questions the ideology, Netsu's story can show how the leader's change affects committed followers.

Current weakness: Netsu has little individual reaction to the collapse of Magma's worldview.

Inae

Role: Principal leader of Team Aqua and ideological antagonist manipulated by Devon.

Established involvement:

- Pursues Magma at Meteor Falls.
- Warns the player that the conflict concerns Hoenn's fate.
- Commands the occupation of the Abandoned Ship and shipping routes.
- Takes an Orb from Mt. Pyre.
- Reaches Kyogre in Seafloor Cavern.
- Awakens Kyogre with the wrong Orb.
- Recognizes the catastrophic result.
- Learns that Mr. Stone used both teams.
- Admits that no human can control the titans.

Arc: Inae initially presents Aqua as the necessary opposition to Magma while remaining convinced of her own superior vision. Her encounter with Kyogre proves that her ideology is equally dangerous. Mr. Stone's reveal strips away the last illusion that she controlled events.

Alejandro

Role: Senior Aqua captain and operational commander.

Established involvement:

- Leads the confrontation involving Captain Stern at the Oceanic Museum.
- Oversees Aqua's relationship with Seabreeze Shipping.
- Arranges disguised cargo movements through Slateport.
- Warns that the Route 121 phase is already underway.

Arc: Alejandro represents Aqua as an organized criminal and logistical network rather than only an ideological cult. He connects the early museum thefts to the later port, shipping, and Mt. Pyre operations.

Current weakness: The exact hierarchy between Alejandro and Inae should be stated clearly on their first appearances.

Groudon

Role: Ancient embodiment of terrestrial power.

Story movement: Mythic destroyer -> sleeping objective of Magma -> uncontrollable awakened titan -> unwilling instrument of Mr. Stone -> force calmed by Rayquaza.

Thematic function: Groudon demonstrates the difference between power and obedience. Awakening it never makes it belong to the person holding an Orb.

Kyogre

Role: Ancient embodiment of oceanic power.

Story movement: Mythic destroyer -> sleeping objective of Aqua -> uncontrollable awakened titan -> unwilling instrument of Mr. Stone -> force calmed by Rayquaza.

Thematic function: Kyogre mirrors Groudon and proves that Aqua's supposedly corrective ideology is no safer than Magma's.

Rayquaza

Role: Balancing legendary and final answer to the physical titan crisis.

Established involvement:

- Is identified through the Cave of Origin legend.
- Sleeps at Sky Pillar.
- Responds when awakened by the player.
- Ends the clash between Primal Groudon and Primal Kyogre.

Thematic function: Rayquaza is balance rather than ownership. It intervenes without becoming anyone's weapon.

Supporting figures

Mr. Briney and Nami

Their rescue gives the player transportation to Dewford and Slateport. They translate an early act of kindness into concrete progress and reinforce the story's recurring principle that helping individuals creates the path forward.

Captain Stern

Stern connects Devon's delivery mission, the museum confrontation, oceanic research, and the stolen submarine. His work unintentionally supplies Aqua with the route to Kyogre.

The Mt. Pyre keepers

They preserve the ancient history, safeguard the Orbs, identify the chosen-one tradition, provide the Magma Emblem, and frame the Nightmare Realm encounter.

Gym Leaders

The Gym Leaders primarily chart the player's growing capability. Calendula and Stella have major dramatic roles beyond this structure; the remaining Leaders serve as regional milestones and representatives of the normal Hoenn the player is protecting.

7. Relationship map

| Relationship | Story function | |---|---| | Player ? Acacia | Investigator and scientific mentor
| | Player ? Calendula | Student and protective mentor; later formal Gym opponents | | Acacia ? Calendula | Research and romantic partners with complementary scientific roles | | Player ? Rival | Parallel growth, field research, and recurring friendly competition | | Player ? Luka | Friendship, repeated testing, and shared pursuit of the comet mystery | | Player ? Aurora | Gifted student and cryptic supernatural teacher | | Player ? Jirachi/Celebi | Chosen mortal and legendary partners maintaining the timeline | | Player ? Stella | Fellow investigator, crisis partner, and eventual Champion opponent | | Stella ? Mr. Stone | Granddaughter and grandfather; partnership/control thematic opposition | | Magnus ? Inae | Ideological enemies who discover they were manipulated by the same patron | | Inae ? Alejandro | Strategic leader and operational captain | | Mr. Stone ? Aqua/Magma | Hidden financier using both organizations as disposable instruments | | Luka ? ruined future | Possible source of his unexplained dreams and temporal sensitivity |

8. Information and reveal schedule

What the player learns early

- Groudon and Kyogre once devastated Hoenn.
- Jirachi, Celebi, the comet, and time restoration are connected.
- The restored world may not be completely stable.
- Acacia suspects reality changed.
- Aurora believes the player carries unusual energy.
- Magma and Aqua are pursuing ancient power.

What the player learns at the midpoint

- The gift allows entry into nightmare rifts.
- Restoring time erases ordinary people's memories.
- The nightmare corruption comes from the broken future.
- Comet-linked meteorites retain unexplained energy.
- Aqua is controlling regional infrastructure, not merely stealing isolated objects.
- Both teams are converging on the sacred Orbs.

What the player learns late

- Shadow Jirachi and Celebi are the broken future's grief given form.
- The titans cannot be controlled through ideology or possession alone.
- The wrong-Orb awakenings were not merely mistakes; Devon fed both teams false information.
- Mr. Stone funded the entire conflict.
- Stella is his granddaughter and the Champion.
- Mr. Stone values economic domination above both ideology and human relationships.
- Rayquaza, not another human control mechanism, is the answer to the titan conflict.

9. Themes and recurring motifs

Memory

The player remembers worlds and disasters others forget. Luka dreams what he cannot consciously remember. The Meteorite itself is described as remembering a forgotten world. Memory is therefore both evidence and burden.

Wishes versus choices

Jirachi represents wishes, but the story repeatedly requires human action. The future is not repaired because someone asks for it; it is repaired because the player chooses to help at every stage.

Research versus exploitation

Acacia, Calendula, and Stella study the unknown in order to understand it. Mr. Stone studies the same mysteries in order to own them. The difference is ethical, not intellectual.

Inheritance

The story contains several forms of inheritance:

- Ancient disasters inherited by the present.
- The Stone family's obsession with minerals and power.
- Stella's relationship to Devon and her grandfather.
- The player's inheritance of memories from a broken future.

- Luka's possible inheritance of temporal echoes.

Control versus partnership

Mr. Stone wants gods to obey him. Magnus and Inae treat the titans as instruments of ideology. The player succeeds through partnership with ordinary Pokemon, human allies, and legendary beings.

Parallel rivals

The rival and Luka reflect different aspects of the player:

- The rival follows the same formal Trainer and research path.
- Luka follows the emotional and supernatural trail of the comet.
- Stella represents the accomplished destination of the Trainer path.
- Aurora represents the dangerous isolation of the gifted path.

10. Continuity decisions required before final story polish

1. How are the Orbs recovered from Mr. Stone?

Mr. Stone leaves with both Orbs, yet Magnus and Inae later possess and return them. Add an explicit recovery event after Rayquaza intervenes.

Cleanest option: Rayquaza's arrival breaks Devon's control system and disables the boat. The Orbs are thrown or washed ashore. Magnus and Inae recover them while Mr. Stone escapes.

2. What happens to Mr. Stone?

The principal human antagonist presently disappears before the League.

Possible answers:

- He escapes and becomes the central postgame antagonist.
- Devon's board removes him, but he remains at large.
- Stella confronts him before the League.
- He is arrested while attempting to flee, giving the main story firmer closure.

Whichever answer is chosen should be acknowledged before Stella's Champion battle.

3. What exactly is the playable prologue?

Choose consistent terminology: dream, time travel, memory, or temporal projection. The later narrative works best if it is a real timeline experienced through a dreamlike projection.

4. Is the gift unique to the player?

Aurora says Luka and the rival do not possess it. Decide whether Aurora also has the gift, can only recognize it, or learned about it through visions. Define whether Luka's dreams are a weaker related phenomenon.

5. Why do the rifts open in those locations?

Petalburg and Mt. Pyre should have explicit causal triggers. Possible causes include comet-energy concentrations, nearby Time Gears, use of the Orbs, or human interference with meteorite energy.

6. How does the villain plot worsen the temporal plot?

The strongest unified answer is that comet energy, Orb resonance, and titan awakenings strain the already repaired timeline. Calendula can discover this scientifically before the climax.

7. What is the exact Aqua hierarchy?

State clearly that Inae is the leader and Alejandro is a captain or senior operations commander. Their first scenes should establish this without relying on later context.

8. What is the player's family relationship to Acacia and Calendula?

The intended scripts establish Acacia and Calendula as romantic and research partners. Legacy text refers to the Petalburg Leader as the player's father. Decide whether either woman is also the player's parent, whether both are guardians, or whether they are unrelated mentors. Then standardize every reference.

9. How does Aurora's arc end?

Aurora needs a final response to the events she predicted. Her conclusion should clarify whether her belief in the comet was vindicated, revised, or challenged.

10. What does Luka finally understand about his dreams?

Victory Road is the natural place to reveal whether the dreams were temporal echoes and whether restoring balance changed them.

11. What is Stella's emotional resolution?

Her Champion dialogue should address:

- Her grandfather's betrayal.
- The corruption of Devon.
- His dismissal of her accomplishments.
- Why she still believes Pokemon partnership matters.
- Why the player is worthy to inherit responsibility for Hoenn.

12. Legacy dialogue cleanup

Late scripts still contain player-facing references to Wallace, Archie, Maxie, Steven, Brendan, Wally, and the player's "father." These should be systematically replaced with Stella, Inae, Magnus, Zenno or Zinnia, Luka, and the final chosen family terminology.

11. Recommended three-act writing structure

The playable story contains many regional episodes, but its dramatic spine can be summarized in three large movements.

Act One - The world has already ended once

- Ruined-future prologue.
- Acacia's investigation.
- Early rival and Luka relationships.
- Aurora's warning.
- Stella's titan painting.
- Meteorite theft and Mt. Chimney.

Act turn: The Petalburg disaster proves the changed timeline is actively breaking.

Act Two - Everyone is trying to choose the future

- Aurora identifies the gifted player.
- Nightmare Petalburg establishes the cost and rules of restoration.
- Aqua's infrastructure campaign expands.
- Calendula studies comet energy.
- Aqua and Magma steal the Orbs.
- The Nightmare Realm reveals the source of the shadows.
- Mr. Stone's presence in the Magma mine links Devon to the conflict.

Act turn: Groudon and Kyogre awaken, proving that all three human power structures have lost control.

Act Three - Control or partnership

- Magma attacks the Space Center.
- Aqua awakens Kyogre.
- The titans clash in Sootopolis.
- Mr. Stone reveals himself and triggers the Primal Reversions.
- The player awakens Rayquaza.
- The Orbs are recovered and returned.
- Mr. Stone's immediate fate is resolved or established as a postgame threat.
- Stella confronts what her family legacy means.
- The player defeats Stella and becomes Champion.

Final thematic answer: The player becomes responsible for Hoenn not because they acquired the greatest power, but because every stage of the journey proved they could be trusted not to possess what they protected.